LVES Charter Working Group — Round 1 Survey (Forms-ready first pass)

Prepared by: J. Quinn (Exos Aerospace) for the LVES Charter Working Group

Date: 2026-08-25

Purpose: Round 1 of a light two-round Delphi. This round *diverges* — it collects scope candidates, desired outcomes, and boundary opinions. Round 2 hands back the consolidated list for members to *rank*, and a prioritized draft charter comes to the next meeting instead of another open discussion.

Platform: Build in MS Forms or Google Forms. Attributed by default, with an anonymous free-text option on the scope-boundary questions (Q3/Q4) so people are candid.

Length target: 12 questions, about 10 minutes. Mostly ranking and multi-select.

Field for: one week from send.

> Build notes for whoever stands up the form are in *[italics/brackets]* and should not be pasted into the live form.

Intro text (paste at top of form):

This short survey shapes the LVES Technical Committee charter. It takes about 10 minutes and is mostly ranking and multi-select. This is Round 1 — we are collecting the full set of scope candidates and desired outcomes. In Round 2 we will hand back a consolidated list for you to prioritize, then bring a draft charter to the next meeting. Where a question offers an anonymous option, feel free to use it so we get candid input on boundaries. Thank you for helping keep this charter sharp rather than shelf-bound.

Q1. Purpose (short answer — required).

In one sentence: why should LVES exist, and who is the primary beneficiary?

[Long-answer text, one line expected.]

Q2. Scope inclusions — rank by priority (ranking — required).

Rank these from highest to lowest priority for the committee to own:

- Expendable launch vehicles (ELVs)
- Reusable launch vehicles (RLVs)
- Upper stages (expendable)
- Reusable upper stages
- In-space servicing, mobility & logistics, and refueling (SM&L / ISAM)
- Entry, descent, and recovery systems
- Hypersonic suborbital rockets (rocket-powered boost/test platforms)
- Rocket-powered hypersonic aircraft
- Airbreathing hypersonic concepts
- Cross-cutting operability, reliability, and safety

[MS Forms ranking question. If ranking of 10 items feels heavy, fall back to "select your top 5" multi-select.]

Q3. Own vs. interface (multi-select grid — required).

For each area below, mark whether LVES should OWN it, treat it as an INTERFACE (coordinate, do not absorb), or leave it OUT.

Rows: ELVs · RLVs · upper stages · reusable upper stages · SM&L/ISAM/refueling · entry & recovery · hypersonic suborbital rockets · rocket-powered hypersonic aircraft · airbreathing hypersonic · operability/reliability/safety.

Columns: Own · Interface · Out.

[Likert/choice grid. This is the question that actually resolves the "core vs. absorb-everything" debate.]

Q4. Explicit exclusions (long answer — optional, anonymous allowed).

What should be deliberately OUT of scope? Constraining the problem matters as much as defining it.

[Provide an "answer anonymously" note here.]

Q5. Interfaces and boundaries (long answer — optional).

Which existing AIAA committees or activities do we overlap, and where should the boundary sit (for example propulsion TCs, hypersonic/high-speed airbreathing, space logistics/ISAM, spaceports, range & safety, GNC)?

Q6. Deliverables — select all that this committee should produce in the next 12–24 months (multi-select — required).

- Named technical sessions / panels at SciTech, AVIATION, ASCEND
- A launch/entry + reusable-upper-stage technology roadmap
- Standards input
- Policy / regulatory input
- Workshops
- White papers
- Lessons-learned / best-practice capture (operability, reliability, safety)
- STEM / university engagement
- Other (specify)

Q7. Top deliverable (single choice — required).

Of the items you selected in Q6, which ONE matters most in the first 12 months?

[Single-choice mirroring Q6 options. Forces a lead priority.]

Q8. Impact measure (short answer — required).

How will we know, one year from now, that this committee mattered? Name one concrete signal.

Q9. Cadence (single choice — required).

How often should the full committee meet?

- Monthly · Every 6 weeks · Quarterly · Twice a year · Other

Q10. Structure (multi-select — required).

Do we need standing subcommittees? Select any that should exist:

- Reusable upper stages / SM&L
- Operability, reliability & safety (standing theme)
- Roadmap & standards
- Hypersonic interface / liaison
- STEM & workforce
- None — keep it a single body
- Other (specify)

Q11. Membership & participation (single choice + short answer — required).

[Directly answers Linton Honda's 8/24 cadence question and the 10-of-50 turnout, and tests the AIAA norm Amrutur Anilkumar cited on 8/24 — annual review, 3-year member term, continuation at the pleasure of TC leadership. Framed opportunity-first, per John Vinson's 8/24 steer: step up activity to create participation before any roster pruning; roster changes run through the normal annual recruiting cycle (revisited Sept for 2027).]

Follow-up A (single choice — the lead question): what most improves participation?

- More ways to contribute (subcommittees to form/chair, real deliverables) · A stricter roster/attendance standard · Both, in that order (opportunities first) · Other

How often should the membership roster be reviewed and refreshed?

- Quarterly · Annually (AIAA norm) · Annually, with a light mid-year participation check · Other

Follow-up B (single choice): the AIAA norm is a member term of up to three years, renewable at TC leadership's discretion. Adopt as-is, shorten, or lengthen?

- Adopt the 3-year term as-is · Shorter term · Longer term · No fixed term · Other

Follow-up C (short answer): if we ever need one, what should the standard be for an "active" member (for example, attends at least half of meetings or contributes to one deliverable/subcommittee per year)? Note this would inform the annual/September review only, not mid-cycle removal.

Q12. Gaps (long answer — required).

Who or what discipline is missing from the table? Name people, organizations, or expertise we should add.

Closing text (paste at bottom of form):

Thank you. Round 2 will return a consolidated, de-duplicated list from these responses for prioritization, and a draft charter with an already-ranked scope will come to the next meeting. Questions to John Quinn.

Assembly note: results map 1:1 onto charter sections — Q1 → Purpose; Q2/Q3/Q4 → Scope (core / interface / exclusions); Q5 → Interfaces; Q6/Q7 → Deliverables; Q8 → Impact measure; Q9/Q10 → Governance & structure; Q11 → Membership & participation; Q12 → Gaps. So the responses assemble the charter rather than just generating discussion.